

VIDEO EDITING • INTERNSHIP PROJECT

Make a Reel Worth Posting

Shoot or gather your own clips, then edit one vertical short under a minute that you would actually post, using every core Premiere Pro skill.

FORMAT

Vertical 9:16

TOOL

**Adobe Premiere
Pro**

One reel under 60 seconds • For Reels and Shorts

REEL

What This Project Is

You will edit one short vertical video, under 1 minute, made to actually post as a reel on Instagram Reels or YouTube Shorts. There is no footage given to you: you either shoot your own or use free stock. You then turn it into a scroll-stopping edit with a strong hook, cuts on the beat, captions, and a satisfying ending.

It is the same Premiere Pro skill set from your course, just wrapped in the format you already scroll every day. The goal is a reel you would be happy to post, that also shows off a full range of editing skills.

Step 1: Pick Your Reel

Choose one idea below. Keep it vertical (9:16) and under 60 seconds.

1 A Day in My Life

A solo day, a morning routine, or a “get ready with me” style edit. Real, relatable moments cut to a chill beat.

Vibe: cozy, personal, easy to relate to

3 Vlog Cut

A day out, a trip, a cafe run, or hanging with friends, cut into a fast and fun highlight reel.

Vibe: fun, fast, in the moment

5 Aesthetic or Mood Reel

Outfit, food, room, or a “romanticize your life” edit. All about vibe, colour, and pacing.

Vibe: dreamy, stylish, colour-led

7 Hobby or Passion Reel

Whatever you are into: gym, cooking, art, gaming, sport, or music, shown in a fast, high-energy cut.

Vibe: energetic, full of personality

2 Mini Story

A tiny story with a twist or a satisfying ending, all in under a minute. A simple idea with a setup, a turn, and a payoff.

Vibe: hook, twist, satisfying finish

4 Restaurant or Shop Intro

A tasty montage of a place, its products, and its vibe, like a promo reel you could actually hand to the owner.

Vibe: appetising, smooth, brand-ready

6 Transformation or Before-After

A glow-up, a room makeover, a recipe reveal, or a project going from messy to finished. Built around a satisfying reveal.

Vibe: buildup then payoff

Step 2: The Reel Rules

These make it feel like a real post, and each one quietly builds a key editing skill.

EVERY REEL MUST HAVE

- Vertical 9:16 and under 60 seconds
- A strong hook in the first 3 seconds, so people do not scroll past
- Cuts timed to the beat of your song
- On-screen captions or text, since most people watch on mute
- A clean loop or a satisfying ending
- Delivered like a real post: video, a cover frame, and a caption

Step 3: Get Your Footage

You are not given any footage. Get your own in one of these two ways (you can mix both):

OPTION A • SHOOT IT YOURSELF

- Shoot vertically (hold the phone upright) so it fits the reel format.
- Keep shots steady and well-lit, and capture variety: wide, close-up, and movement.
- Film more than you think you need, so you have options while editing.

OPTION B • USE FREE STOCK FOOTAGE

- Download free, license-free clips that fit your idea.
- Good free sites: Pexels, Pixabay, Mixkit, Coverr.
- Free music and sound effects: YouTube Audio Library, Pixabay Music, Mixkit.

Ground Rules

- Edit in Adobe Premiere Pro.
- Vertical 9:16, under 60 seconds.
- Use only your own footage or free, license-free stock. Same for music and sound effects.
- Show a range of skills (see the techniques list), not just simple cuts.
- Do your own work. Study other creators for style, do not copy their edits.

Step 4: The Editing Stages

01 Set Up and Import

Get the reel project ready

- Create a new project and organise your clips into bins (folders).
- Create a vertical 9:16 sequence (1080 x 1920) with the right settings.
- Get familiar with the timeline, source monitor, and key panels.
- Import all your footage, music, and any graphics.

DELIVERABLE

An organised project and a vertical sequence, ready to edit.

02 Rough Cut and Hook

Grab attention in 3 seconds

- Lay your clips on the timeline in the order that tells your story.
- Trim and cut clips, and remove the boring or shaky bits.
- Nail a strong hook in the first 3 seconds, then cut to the beat.

DELIVERABLE

A rough cut with a strong opening hook, timed to the music.

03 Titles and Captions

Make it readable on mute

- Add text with the type tool and shapes, plus on-screen captions.
- Make an intro where footage shows through the text (footage-into-text).
- Design an animated motion banner or end card, and add a short photo montage moment.

DELIVERABLE

Captions, an intro, a motion banner or end card, and a photo moment.

04 Animation and Transitions

The trendy moving text

- Animate text and graphics with keyframes (the pop-up text look).
- Use nesting to group and manage clips neatly.
- Add transitions, including at least one transition preset.

DELIVERABLE

Keyframe animations, at least one nest, and smooth transitions.

05 Effects and Tracking

Captions that follow you

- Add an adjustment layer and apply effects on top of your footage.
- Track a moving object so a caption or graphic follows the subject.
- Use at least one template or third-party plugin (such as Mr Horse).

DELIVERABLE

An adjustment layer with effects, one tracked caption or graphic, and one plugin or template.

06 Colour and Audio

Set the vibe, clean the sound

- Do colour correction (fix exposure and white balance), then colour grading (set the mood).
- Apply a LUT for a cinematic look.
- Clean and balance the audio: music levels, sound effects, and remove noise.

DELIVERABLE

A corrected and graded reel with a before and after, plus a clean audio mix.

07 Export

Render it out clean

- Export vertical (1080 x 1920, H.264) with a clean loop or satisfying ending.
- Create a cover frame (thumbnail) for your reel.
- Write a short breakdown showing where you used each technique.

DELIVERABLE

The final reel, a cover frame, and a short breakdown.

Level-Up Challenges *(Bonus)*

Optional, for extra credit. Pull off any of these to stand out:

GO THE EXTRA MILE

- A seamless or invisible transition
- A speed ramp (slow motion into fast motion)
- Text behind the subject (masking)
- A tight velocity edit synced to the beat
- Custom sound design or added sound effects

How to Submit

- 1 Compile all your files (final reel, project file, cover frame, and your breakdown) into a single folder named **YourName_ReelEditing_Assignment**.
- 2 Compress the folder into a ZIP file.
- 3 Upload the ZIP file (or the entire folder) to your **Google Drive**.
- 4 Right-click the file / folder in Google Drive and enable sharing access (set to '**Anyone with the link can view**').
- 5 Copy the shareable Google Drive link.
- 6 Log in to your **iStudio dashboard** and go to the **Assignments** section under the Video Editing Internship.
- 7 Paste the Google Drive link in the submission box before the assignment deadline.
- 8 Click **Submit** to complete your submission.

Important Notes

- Do **NOT** use copyrighted music, footage, or sound effects. Use only royalty-free sources like Pexels, Pixabay, Mixkit, Coverr, YouTube Audio Library, Freesound, or Free Music Archive. Credit all sources in your breakdown.
- Your reel must be edited in **Adobe Premiere Pro**. Files made only in CapCut, InShot, or other mobile editors will not be accepted.
- Your final reel must be vertical (1080 x 1920) and under 60 seconds. Submissions in the wrong format will not be accepted.
- Audio mixing matters. Avoid clipping or unbalanced sound. Music should not overpower voiceover or key sound effects.
- If your project file (.prproj) is too large to upload, you can upload just the file (without media) and include a screen recording of your timeline as backup.
- Double-check that your Google Drive link is set to '**Anyone with the link can view**', otherwise your submission cannot be reviewed.
- Late submissions may not be accepted. Submit before the deadline.